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General Comment

AI is deeply concerning to me. It is enormously wasteful, expending truly ridiculous amounts of energy to shuffle training data around to create the facsimile of intelligence. There is no future for America with AI. Anyone pushing for AI development should be certain it operates only under heavy regulations.

AI is fundamentally intellectual theft. Training data is needed to make any progress at all. But all training data that gets made by the creativity of human beings--whether it's art, books, music, video, or anything else. AI is taking work created by humans, reorganizing it and pretending to have made something novel. This theft of intellectual property is a violation of copyright, and it is a deeply cynical thing to do with the sum total of human knowledge.

AI is an excuse to fire human beings. A wide variety of industries have sought to replace human labor with AI, reducing jobs and ruining livelihoods and communities. AI can never acquire the lived experience of humans, something that makes us uniquely able to be flexible and respond in sensible ways to novel situations. Even if AI could learn this skillset, which is unlikely given the power of human empathy and creativity, why would it be needed when we have human beings who already have that capacity now.

Contrary to appearances, AI does not and cannot comprehend what it says or what is said to it. It is fundamentally incapable of understanding. AI doesn't learn language, it learns patterns in data and replicates those patterns. It learns what words follow other words, and uses those to make reasonable-sounding replies that can range from deeply wrong to dangerous to simply nonsensical in context. AI should never be used for decision making and should never be used for anything without close human oversight.

The regulations that were in place were a beginning, but far more is needed. Companies that want to train AI models must ensure they use data ethically acquired and with consent of the creators, limiting their maximum energy usage, etc.

The results of deregulating AI would be bleak for Americans and America.

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Thank you for your time,
Elizabeth Jameson, priest